A LITTLE STORY, TOGETHER

drift

Six words from you. Six from a stranger.

A daily co-op writing game.
Two writers. One postcard to keep.

CATCH A BEGINNING ADD SIX WORDS KEEP YOUR STORY



Actual hosted postcard export · Synthetic demonstration text · Live Claude checks

A little story, together.

Drift is a daily co-op writing game where two strangers turn two six-word lines into a postcard they both keep.

01
Catch

Unfold another writer's beginning.

02
Finish

Add six words of your own.

03
Keep

Save the story you made together.

Then, optionally toss your own beginning for the next person. Three rounds daily, one completion stamp. No profile or contact exchange is needed for the main game.

Play Drift **Source repository (private)**

Hosted prototype. Final normal-user bot-check-to-export rehearsal remains pending.

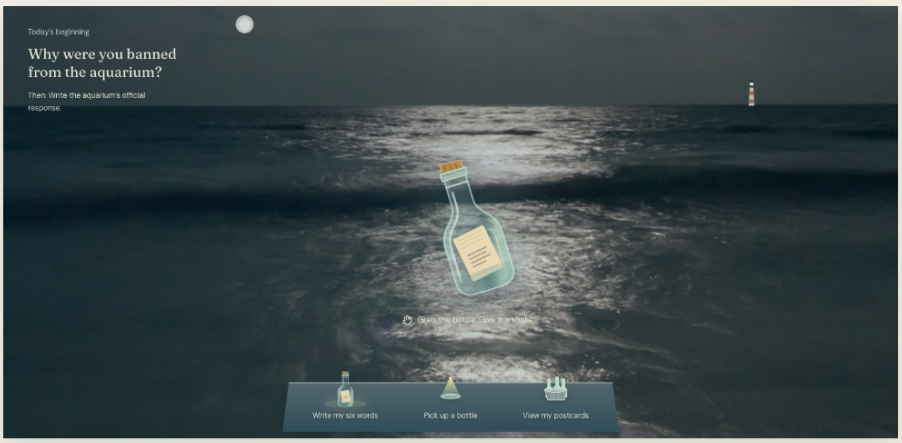
THE EXPERIENCE

A small invitation.

01 / WASH UP ON THE SHORE

A small prompt. A place to begin.

Catch someone's beginning before writing anything.
Shaking, buttons and keyboard all lead to the same exchange.



TODAY'S PROMPT

Why were you banned from the aquarium?

Then: write the aquarium's official response.

LOW PRESSURE BY DESIGN

No profile to perfect.
Just six words to contribute.

Actual local product capture · Sandbox, AI checks off · No attendee participation

DRIFT / CAL HACKS 13.0 — Catch → finish → reveal → optionally toss your own beginning — 02 / 05

The prompt gives two people a shared starting point.

For the aquarium prompt, one writer explains why they were banned. The next writes the aquarium's official response. The six-word limit keeps each contribution small while leaving room for an unexpected turn.

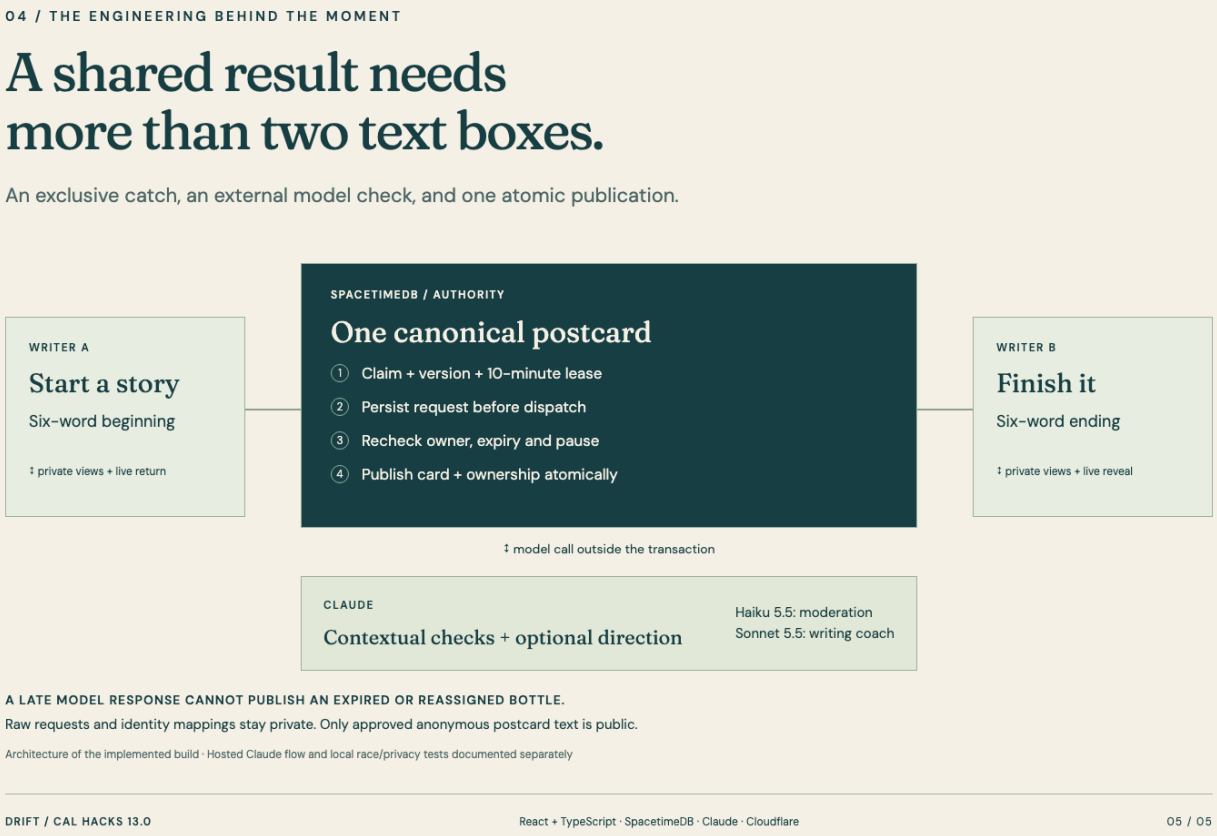
The reveal is the main event.

When the second writer seals the postcard, its original author receives the same approved pair through a live subscription. Both can keep it in their collection, save an image, or share a link. Leaving another beginning is optional.

Our intended audience is first-time event attendees who might enjoy a creative task before an introduction. That is a design hypothesis; there has not yet been an attendee pilot or measured social outcome.

THE ENGINEERING

One story. One shared state.



A successful model answer is not enough to publish.

The bottle may have expired or changed hands while Claude was checking it. Drift persists the request before dispatch, then rechecks the live owner, version, deadline, withdrawal, and pause state before finalizing the postcard.

SpacetimeDB

Authoritative claims, private participant views, atomic card and authorship publication, and subscriptions that deliver the same result to both writers.

Claude

Haiku 5.5 checks setups and completed pairs. Sonnet 5.5 suggests a direction when requested. Players supply both creative lines; uncertain checks withhold publication.

React + TypeScript + Vite on Cloudflare. Canvas exports the card; native WebGL animates sea and paper with static/CSS and reduced-motion alternatives. Server-side Turnstile and scheduled retention are implemented.

THE EVIDENCE

What works today.

43
server tests pass

14
unit / contract tests pass

50
valid model outputs

Hosted exchange

A real Cloudflare/Maincloud two-browser run completed Claude setup checks, a contextual hint, pair moderation, live return, and PNG export with synthetic writers. It preceded Turnstile activation and the newer catch-first revision.

Current catch-first flow

An isolated local sandbox test verified catching before writing, immediate postcard completion, the live return, and optional giving afterward. AI checks were off. Separate hosted negative tests rejected forged tokens and unverified identities.

Evaluation and software checks

In a 50-case live synthetic evaluation, moderation matched 35 of 36 development labels; one harmless case was conservatively withheld. Fourteen hints received Codex review for grounding and authorship boundaries. This is agent review, not independent human validation. Production build and TypeScript checks pass; documented browser scans found no automated accessibility violations in tested states.

Next verification

Rehearse the current hosted game through the enabled bot challenge on physical phones; improve hint tone; supply human-written starters for quiet rooms; run a small consent-based attendee pilot. No adoption, friendship, loneliness, or broad safety outcome is claimed.

Sources and image credits

Technical records: hosted-smoke.json, hosted-gate.json, catch-first.json, live-release.md, and the 50-case evaluation in the repository. Full evidence mapping and source-image provenance accompany this package.

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